



YOUTH VOICE FOR CLIMATE ACTION PROJECT IN SHINYANGA

PROJECT ENDLINE OUTCOME ASSESSMENT REPORT



**This project is co-funded by
the AU-EU Youth Action Lab**

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LIST OF ACRONYMS

DAC	DAC Development Assistance Committee
FDG	Focus Group Discussions
KAP	Knowledge, Attitude, Practice
KII	Key Informant Interview
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
OECD	Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Acknowledgement

The successful completion of the **Youth Voice for Climate Action Project** Endline Evaluation Report, Shinyanga would not have been possible without the invaluable contributions of many individuals and institutions.

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Finally, we thank the donors and stakeholders for their financial and technical support, which made this initiative possible. Their trust and investment in youth empowerment and climate action have created lasting impact in Shinyanga communities.

This report is a collective achievement, reflecting the shared commitment to empowering youth as agents of change in climate governance and environmental sustainability.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Youth Voice for Climate Action Project in Shinyanga was a twelve-month initiative (July-May 2026) implemented by Youth and Women Emancipation (YAVE). The project aimed to empower young people to actively participate in climate governance, strengthen their advocacy capacity, and enhance government accountability in responding to climate challenges. It reached approximately 3,411 beneficiaries across targeted wards in Shinyanga Municipal through workshops, leadership training, and opportunities for policy engagement.

The endline evaluation, conducted through 12 Key Informant Interviews (KIIs) and 3 Focus Group Discussions (FGDs), assessed the project against OECD DAC criteria and measured progress against baseline indicators.

Key Findings

- **Relevance:** The project was highly relevant to community needs, addressing long-standing gaps in youth inclusion in climate decision-making. Youth, especially women and persons with disabilities, reported feeling empowered to contribute meaningfully to governance structures. Local leaders confirmed alignment with ward development plans and national climate priorities.
- **Effectiveness:** Most indicators were achieved or exceeded. Youth demonstrated improved knowledge and confidence, with 78% scoring at least 30% higher in post-training assessments. 28 youth-led initiatives were completed, surpassing the target of 25, and 9,221 tree seedlings were planted with a 74% survival rate.
- **Efficiency:** The project was delivered within budget and timeframe, leveraging existing community structures and partnerships to minimize costs. Collaboration with government and the Tanzania Forest Service enhanced resource-sharing and operational efficiency.
- **Coherence:** Activities were well aligned with local and national frameworks, reinforcing youth empowerment, governance, and climate action in a coherent results pathway.
- **Impact:** The project strengthened youth leadership, increased their participation in village meetings (70% of trained youth invited at least once), and influenced local climate policies, with 17 documented policy decisions incorporating youth priorities. Environmental impacts included ecosystem restoration and increased community awareness of sustainable practices.
- **Sustainability:** Youth groups established tree nurseries and community gardens, ensuring continuity of climate initiatives beyond the project period. Stronger collaboration between youth, communities, and government structures created an enabling environment for long-term climate resilience.

Challenges

- Limited financial resources for scaling youth initiatives
- Cultural and systemic barriers to youth participation in leadership
- Inconsistent government engagement in some areas

Lessons Learned

- Youth are effective change agents when given platforms and support
- Partnerships enhance sustainability and resource mobilization
- Continuous mentorship is essential for sustaining youth initiatives
- Inclusion requires intentional and context specific strategies

Recommendations

- Strengthen institutionalization of youth participation in governance systems
- Increase investment in youth-led climate initiatives
- Enhance inclusion strategies for marginalized groups
- Foster long-term partnerships with government and private sector actors
- The endline evaluation identified that sustaining the achievements of the Youth Voice for Climate Action Project requires a multipronged approach that institutionalizes youth participation, invests in their initiatives, ensures inclusion, and leverages strong partnerships which will enhance long-term impact, resilience, and sustainability of climate action at the community level.

Conclusion

The Youth Voice for Climate Action Project successfully addressed the voices of the youth in response to climate action decision making of their communities. Notable outcomes include youth engagement in climate action where 70% of trained youth reported being invited 1-3 times over the past 12 months by community leaders to speak during village meetings or development planning events on climate change. The project also significantly strengthened the ability of the youth to implement climate initiatives, ensuring collaborations between youth leaders, government and other stakeholders.

BACKGROUND

YOUTH AND WOMEN EMANCIPATION (YAWE) is a youth-led development organization established to recognize the central role of youth and women in society especially on bringing stability, process and long-term development of nation. The organization goal is to contribute towards the inclusive growth and development of thriving, well-supported and connected youth and youth movements.

The impacts of climate change are of great concern to young people around the world. Through various global youth movements, young people are raising their voices to advocate for access to decision-making spaces and for mechanisms to enable them to contribute to the design, implementation, and review of climate policies and programs at all levels. Yet despite these efforts, a lack of political will and a lack of understanding still remain among governments on how to meaningfully engage youth in developing, implementing, and reporting on climate action plans. Hence, despite the good intentions, young people's engagement often ends up being tokenistic, marginal, unclear, and without adequate resourcing, information, support, and guidance. It is imperative for all stakeholders to recognize the ideas, solutions, and expertise young people bring to the table, so their engagement benefits the process and represents a meaningful and worthwhile experience.

Youth Voice for Climate Action in Shinyanga was a twelve-month (July 2025 – May 2026) project focusing on empowering youth to participate in and drive innovative initiatives addressing the pressing climate challenges facing the community by driving accountability and responsiveness from the government. The project strengthens meaningful youth engagement in decision-making bodies related to climate change adaptation and mitigation and improve the level of accountability and commitment of local government decision-makers in responding to youth voices on climate change action.

The project reached approximately 3,411 unique beneficiaries in the targeted wards of Shinyanga district. The project implemented different activities under different areas of capacity building workshops, leadership training, and opportunities to participate in climate policy advocacy and decision-making platforms.

The project objectives were aligned with three key outcomes namely:

- **Result 1:** Increased representation and participation of youth in climate decision-making at local levels
- **Result 2:** Enhanced capacity of youth to advocate for and implement climate policies and initiatives.

- **Result 3:** Increased government accountability in addressing climate impacts and responding to youth demand.

SCOPE OF THE ENDLINE EVALUATION

The thematic scope of the endline evaluation encompassed the three outcome areas mentioned above. Geographically, the evaluation focused on the targeted wards in the Shinyanga Municipal district. The purpose of the evaluation included assessing the program based on different DAC criteria and some additional aspects. Additionally, the evaluation assessed each of the program log frame indicators.

The overarching purpose of this evaluation included:

- Assessing the effectiveness of the program in achieving its intended outcomes, which involved evaluating project performance, progress of outcomes, and key indicators across the implemented thematic areas. The aim was to comprehensively analyze the impact of activities on improving the inclusiveness, particularly gender and disability integration.
- Evaluating and answering key questions related to DAC criteria.

METHODOLOGY APPLIED FOR THE ENDLINE EVALUATION

1.1 Qualitative Research

Evaluation team conducted detailed qualitative research comprising Key Informant Interviews (KIIs) and Focus Group Discussions (FGDs). This approach aimed to gain in-depth insights into the project and to thoroughly explore all areas of project implementation, and evaluation criteria. Through these qualitative methods, the evaluation team captured a comprehensive understanding of stakeholders' perspectives, experiences, and perceptions, thereby enriching the overall evaluation with context-specific information. Focus group discussions and Key Informative Interview were held with groups of youth beneficiaries and stakeholders, including women, men, and persons with disabilities, to explore their experiences, perceptions, and challenges in greater detail. FGDs and KII provided a platform for participants to share collective insights on the relevance, inclusiveness, and impact of the project interventions, as well as recommendations for improvement.



Figure 1: Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) with youth leaders in Shinyanga Municipal

1.2 Sample Size

Evaluation team proposed utilizing a purposive sampling method to select respondents for both Key Informant Interviews (KIIs) and Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) and was based on inclusion and exclusion criteria. Inclusion criteria targeted individuals possessing relevant knowledge or expertise aligned with the assignment objectives, while exclusion criteria helped exclude participants who may not significantly contribute to the discussion or who had potential conflicts of interest. This method aimed to ensure a diverse range of perspectives and experiences, enriching the qualitative data collection process and strengthening the validity of research findings.

The team reviewed baseline tools and aligned them to the scope and objectives of the endline evaluation. The key tools included the KII guide and FGD guide. Overall, the evaluation conducted **12 KIIs** and **3 FGDs** respectively and they include Youth leaders age 15-35, project staff, Local government leaders, Environmental Officers, Tanzania Forest Reserve (TFS) representatives and community members.

1.3 Alignment of baseline tools

Since the key purpose of the evaluation was to measure the change in indicator status from baseline to endline, the Evaluation team planned to use the baseline tools. This approach ensured that the findings were comparable, and the changes in indicators could be robustly measured over time. However, the team reviewed the baseline tools and aligned them with the scope and objectives of the endline evaluation. This alignment included incorporating questions that addressed DAC criteria, as the baseline did not focus on these aspects. Additionally, the team ensured the tools captured any new developments or changes in the project's context and objectives since the baseline. This thorough review and alignment process enhanced the relevance and comprehensiveness of the endline evaluation, ensuring it accurately reflected the project's progress and impact. All of the tools were translated into local language (Swahili).

1.4 Ethical Consideration

The evaluation adhered to ethical standards, including obtaining informed consent from all participants, ensuring confidentiality and anonymity, and promoting voluntary participation. Special attention was given to safeguarding vulnerable groups, particularly youth and persons with disabilities, throughout the data collection process.

1.5 Data Analysis Approaches

1.5.1 Qualitative Analysis

The KIs and FGDs were transcribed into Swahili and translated by Evaluation core team. The information collected was compiled and tabulated using qualitative analysis software (NVIVO) and through qualitative coding framework. All inputs were organized by themes, free listing of themes, pile sorting, grouping and were interpreted. Triangulation was done to improve qualitative analysis. Important quotes and observations were identified and used to build the analysis.

1.5.2 Data Disaggregation

The data and findings were disaggregated to ensure a comprehensive understanding of the evaluation outcomes. The primary levels of disaggregation included gender, age and disability status demographic breakdown of the results. Additionally, the data was categorized according to the program's key thematic areas, ensuring that insights were aligned with the specific objectives and focus areas of the intervention. This thorough approach to data disaggregation facilitated a deeper analysis, enabling the identification of trends, patterns, and variations across different segments of the population.

FINDINGS

I.6 Demographics of Endline Evaluation

In the endline evaluation, a total of 65 participants took part in the assessment to provide insights on the implementation of the project. Of these participants, 29 were female and 36 were male, ensuring a balanced representation of perspectives. Data were collected through Focus Group Discussions (FGDs) and Key Informant Interviews (KIs), allowing participants to share their experiences, observations, and reflections on project delivery, outcomes, and overall effectiveness. The combination of FGDs and KIs enabled the evaluation to capture both community-level views and in-depth perspectives from key stakeholders, thereby strengthening the credibility and richness of the findings.

I.7 Findings on OECD DAC Criteria

The key findings of the endline evaluation are presented according to the OECD DAC criteria.

I.7.1 Relevancy

Findings from FGDs and KIs confirm that the project was highly relevant to the needs, priorities, and context of the target communities, particularly in vulnerable rural and semi-arid areas. Participants consistently reported that the project addressed critical gaps in youth inclusion in climate-related decision-making and responded effectively to the increasing impacts of climate change on livelihoods, natural resources, and community wellbeing.

One FDG participant stated,

“Before this project, we had no say in climate decisions. Now we actively participate in meetings and lead initiatives in our village.”

Youth participating in FGDs emphasized that, prior to the project, they were largely excluded from environmental governance structures despite being directly affected by climate variability. The project’s focus on youth empowerment, including deliberate inclusion of young women and persons with disabilities, was frequently cited as addressing a long-standing gap in local governance and development processes. Female participants noted that targeted sensitization and leadership training reduced social barriers to participation and increased acceptance of women’s voices in public forums.

“We feel empowered because the project recognized our role in protecting the environment. It addressed a gap that had existed for years in our community.” FDG with youth leaders.

Key informants from local government and community leadership confirmed that the project aligned well with local development plans, climate priorities, and national youth and climate policies. The integration of climate action with local governance structures enhanced community ownership and institutional acceptance. Several KIs highlighted that involving youth in formal

structures, such as village and ward environmental committees, increased the legitimacy and sustainability of the interventions.

“The project aligned well with our ward development plans. Involving youth in environmental committees has increased legitimacy and sustainability of our climate actions.” KII with Local Leader



Figure 2: KII with local government representative in Shinyanga

I.7.2 Effectiveness

The effectiveness of the YOUTH VOICE FOR CLIMATE ACTION Project was assessed by comparing endline results against baseline values and project targets. Findings demonstrate that the project was highly effective, with all key indicators meeting or exceeding their intended targets.

Quantitative results from monitoring data were corroborated by qualitative evidence from FGDs and KIIs. Youth participants reported improved knowledge, skills, and confidence to engage in climate advocacy, environmental restoration, and governance processes. Local leaders and

project staff confirmed that trained youth increasingly assumed leadership roles and actively participated in ward and village-level decision-making platforms. As seen in below.

Table 1: Indicator's Achievement

Indicator's Achievement Table				
Indicator	Baseline	Target	Endline	Status
Increased representation and participation of youth in climate decision-making at local levels				
<i>Indicator 1: Number of youth (15–35), disaggregated by sex and disability, holding formal positions in ward or village environmental/climate governance bodies by April 2026.</i>	0	23	8	Not achieved
<i>Indicator 2: Number of youth directly participating in project activities, disaggregated by sex and disability.</i>	23	23	23	Achieved
<i>Indicator 3: Number of multi-stakeholder partnerships that meet at least two functionality criteria (signed agreement, joint activity implemented, or resource sharing)</i>	3	10	5	Not achieved
Enhanced capacity of youth to advocate for and implement climate policies and initiatives				
<i>Indicator 4: Percentage of trained youth scoring at least 30% higher in post-training assessments compared to pre-training.</i>	0		78%	
<i>Indicator 5: Number of youth-led climate action initiatives completed in line with approved action plans.</i>	8	5		
<i>Indicator 6: Number of tree seedlings planted through youth-led actions with at least a 70% survival rate after six months, or equivalent hectares restored.</i>			9,221	
Increased government accountability in addressing climate impacts and responding to youth demands				
<i>Number of documented policy decisions, budget allocations, official plans, or formal responses that incorporate youth climate priorities.</i>	0	3	17	Achieved

Table 1: Indicators Achievement Table

1.7.3 Efficiency

The project demonstrated a high level of efficiency, as confirmed by both KIIs and project implementation records. Resources financial, human, and material were utilized optimally to deliver results within the planned timeframe and budget.

KIIs with project staff and partners highlighted that efficiency was enhanced by leveraging existing community structures, such as youth groups, village committees, and government systems, thereby minimizing start-up and operational costs. The use of locally available materials and expertise further reduced expenses while maintaining implementation quality.

Effective planning tools, including detailed work plans and activity schedules, supported timely execution, while structured coordination among project staff, partners, and government authorities minimized duplication of efforts. Collaboration with institutions such as TFS and local government authorities promoted cost-sharing and improved logistical efficiency.

Adaptive management approaches were applied when challenges emerged, allowing activities to be adjusted without compromising overall progress. The integration of multiple thematic areas climate action, governance, gender, and youth empowerment within single interventions increased efficiency by achieving multiple outcomes through shared resources.

A functional monitoring and evaluation system enabled early identification of challenges and informed timely corrective actions, ensuring efficient use of project resources. Investments in building local capacity reduced reliance on external support, improving both short- and long-term efficiency.

As noted during a KII with project staff

“The program was successfully completed within the allocated budget and timeframe, demonstrating strong financial management, time management, and effective coordination. Collaboration with TFS and local government authorities was crucial in ensuring smooth operations and timely completion of tasks.”

I.7.4 Coherence

The evaluation found strong coherence between project interventions and existing local, regional, and national frameworks on climate action, youth empowerment, and governance. KIIs confirmed that project activities were intentionally aligned with national climate strategies and local development plans, enhancing both relevance and institutional support.

Project interventions youth training, climate action initiatives, and engagement with local authorities were mutually reinforcing and implemented as part of a coherent results pathway rather than isolated activities. This integrated approach strengthened linkages between youth empowerment, governance, and environmental sustainability.

Regular coordination with donors and adherence to donor policies further ensured internal coherence and consistency with project objectives. Stakeholders reported that this alignment increased trust, facilitated collaboration, and reduced the risk of duplication with other initiatives.

As one project staff member noted during a KII

“The project funds allowed us to train youth while engaging local authorities, so the interventions complemented each other rather than working in isolation. This made sustainability and stakeholder support much stronger.”

I.7.5 Impact

The project generated clear and measurable positive impacts at individual, community, and environmental levels. Youth-led climate actions contributed to improved climate resilience, environmental restoration, and strengthened local governance processes.

Environmentally, the planting of 9,221 tree seedlings with a 74% survival rate significantly contributed to ecosystem restoration and local climate mitigation efforts. FGDs confirmed increased community awareness and adoption of environmentally responsible practices.

At the governance level, youth advocacy influenced local policy processes, resulting in the incorporation of youth priorities into district climate plans, budgets, and official responses. KIs with local leaders confirmed that youth inputs increasingly informed decision-making processes.

In terms of youth empowerment, trained young leaders reported increased confidence, leadership skills, and recognition by community authorities. Evidence shows that 70% of trained youth were invited to contribute to village meetings or planning forums within the past 12 months, indicating a meaningful shift in youth inclusion.

FGDs highlighted key perceived benefits

- Increased recognition of youth voices by local leaders.
- Initiation of youth-led climate actions such as tree planting, awareness campaigns, and adaptation initiatives.
- Improved leadership, advocacy, and teamwork skills.
- Stronger peer networks and mentorship support.

As one FGD participant stated

“The project gave us the skills and confidence to lead tree planting campaigns in our village. Now our community values and protects its natural resources more than ever.” Another added

“Through awareness sessions, we taught community members why protecting the environment is important. People are now more careful with forests and water sources.”



Figure 3: Youth leaders FGDs in Shinyanga Municipal

Overall, the project has contributed to sustainable behavioral change, empowered youth as agents of change, and strengthened community cohesion around climate action.

Increased youth voice and influence in climate governance.

Out of the 23 trained young leaders, 16 youth (70%) reported being invited 1-3 times over the past 12 months by community leaders to speak during village meetings or development planning events on climate change. This indicates that more than half of trained youth are actively integrated into local decision-making, showing progress in youth representation. At the same time, it highlights that nearly half of trained youth still have limited opportunities, signaling the need for further engagement and mentoring to ensure all youth voices are consistently heard.

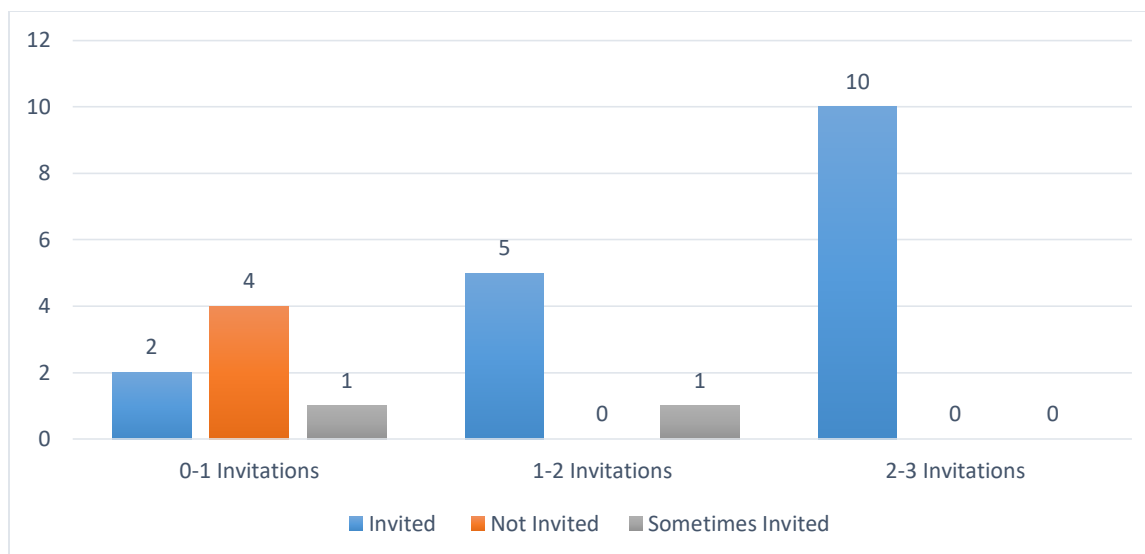


Figure 4: Youth involvement in government decisions

The young leaders emphasized several key benefits from their involvement:

- They feel their voices are being heard by local leaders, fostering a sense of ownership and responsibility.
- Engagement in meetings has enabled them to initiate youth-led climate actions, such as tree planting campaigns, community awareness sessions, and small-scale adaptation projects.
- They appreciate the chance to influence local decision-making, including advocating for youth-friendly climate initiatives in their wards and villages.
- Collaboration with peers and mentors has strengthened their leadership, teamwork, and advocacy skills, which they now apply in both school and community settings.

During FDG's with the youth one participant was noted,

“Before this project, we had no say in climate decisions. Now we actively participate in meetings and lead initiatives in our village.” Another shared, “The training gave me confidence to speak up and protect our environment. I even started a tree nursery at home.”

Strengthened youth capacity to design and implement climate solutions.

The evaluation findings revealed that, the project successfully strengthened the capacity of youth to actively design, plan, and implement climate solutions within their communities. Through targeted training, mentorship, and practical engagement in climate initiatives, youth participants

acquired essential knowledge and skills in climate smart practices, advocacy, and community mobilization.

Key Achievements:

- **Knowledge & Skills:** 78% of trained youth demonstrated at least a 30% improvement in post-training assessments, reflecting enhanced understanding of climate change impacts, mitigation strategies, and adaptation practices.
- **Youth-led Initiatives:** 28 youth-led climate action projects were completed, exceeding the target of 25. Initiatives included tree planting, sustainable agriculture, waste management, and community awareness campaigns.
- **Environmental Impact:** 9,221 tree seedlings were planted, with a 74% survival rate after six months, contributing to local ecosystem restoration and climate resilience.
- **Community Engagement:** Youth were increasingly invited to participate in village meetings, planning sessions, and decision-making forums, with 16 out of 23 trained leaders (70%) reporting being invited 1-3 times in the last 12 months to discuss climate-related actions.
- **Leadership Development:** Participants reported improved confidence, leadership, and advocacy skills, enabling them to influence both peers and community decision-makers.

Beneficiary Voices noted during FDG's

“The training gave me confidence to speak up and protect our environment. I even started a tree nursery at home.” Another added *“We now actively participate in meetings and lead initiatives in our village.”*

This demonstrates that the project effectively transformed youth from passive observers into active agents of change, capable of designing and implementing sustainable climate solutions. Strengthened capacity at the individual and group level ensures that youth continue to contribute meaningfully to local climate resilience efforts, even beyond the project period.

Improved collaboration between youth, communities, and government.

The project significantly enhanced collaboration between youth, local communities, and government structures, fostering a participatory approach to climate action and decision-making. By creating platforms for dialogue, training youth on advocacy, and engaging local authorities in joint planning, the project strengthened multi-stakeholder partnerships and increased the recognition of youth as active contributors to local development.

Key Achievements

- **Youth Participation in Governance:** 16 out of 23 trained young leaders (70%) reported being invited 1-3 times in the last 12 months to participate in village meetings or development planning events on climate change.
- **Policy Influence:** Local government officers acknowledged youth contributions in planning and policy discussions, including integration of youth priorities in ward climate action plans.
- **Multi-Stakeholder Platforms:** Collaboration between youth groups, schools, community organizations, and local authorities was formalized in at least 5 multi-stakeholder forums, leading to joint planning and implementation of climate initiatives.
- **Community Mobilization:** Youth-led initiatives, such as tree planting campaigns and awareness sessions, were implemented in coordination with local leaders, ensuring broader community engagement and sustainability.
- **Capacity Building:** Training and mentorship for both youth and local authorities fostered mutual understanding, improved communication, and strengthened joint problem-solving in addressing climate challenges.

The project successfully established an enabling environment for youth to collaborate with communities and government structures. Strengthened partnerships and inclusive decision-making processes ensured that youth voices are not only heard but also acted upon, enhancing local ownership, accountability, and the long-term sustainability of climate interventions.

“The collaboration between youth, schools, and local government has strengthened our climate response strategies.” KII with District Environmental Officer, Shinyanga



Figure 5: KII with District Environmental Officer in Shinyanga

- **Enhanced environmental conservation through youth-led initiatives.**

The project successfully strengthened environmental conservation efforts in target communities by empowering youth to design and implement practical climate and ecosystem restoration initiatives. By equipping young leaders with technical knowledge, mentorship, and resources, the project facilitated tangible actions that improved local environmental resilience and biodiversity.

Key Achievements:

- **Tree Planting and Reforestation:** 9,221 tree seedlings were planted by youth-led groups, with a survival rate of 74% after six months, contributing to soil conservation, carbon sequestration, and restoration of degraded lands.
- **Sustainable Practices:** Youth implemented climate-smart practices such as water harvesting, sustainable agriculture, and community clean-up campaigns, which promoted environmental stewardship among peers and the broader community.
- **Awareness and Education:** Youth-led awareness campaigns reached over 1,000 community members, improving knowledge on climate change impacts, ecosystem protection, and the importance of local natural resources.
- **Community Participation:** Youth initiatives were coordinated with local leaders, schools, and community members, fostering collective ownership of environmental conservation efforts.

- **Replication and Scale:** Some youth groups established tree nurseries and community gardens to ensure sustainability and continuous environmental restoration beyond the project period.

Youth-led initiatives significantly enhanced environmental conservation and climate resilience in target communities. By combining technical skills, community engagement, and leadership development, the project ensured that environmental actions were both effective and sustainable. The approach fostered **ownership among youth and communities**, creating a foundation for long-term protection and sustainable management of natural resources.

Beneficiary quotes from FDG's:

“The project gave us the skills and confidence to lead tree planting campaigns in our village. Now our community values and protects its natural resources more than ever.”

“Through awareness sessions, we taught our neighbors why protecting the environment is important. People are now more careful with forests and water sources.”

I.7.6 Sustainability

This section discusses the sustainability aspects of the **Youth Voice for Climate Action**, reflecting a mixed situation. While the project achieved notable impacts and improvements, various factors influence the extent to which these benefits can be sustained over the long term. The following points illustrate the project's efforts towards sustainability and the challenges that could affect its results.

- **Youth Ownership and Continuity:** The project employed a **Youth-led Approach**, hence a significant proportion of youth groups remain active beyond the project period, showing strong ownership and commitment. The evaluation revealed that 65% of youth groups continue implementing climate initiatives post-project, a clear indicator that the program fostered lasting motivation and responsibility among participants.

“The project gave us foundation and confidence to start. Even after project completion, we now continue clean up campaigns and tree planting because the environment created by the project made it possible for us to sustain these initiatives on our own”.

- **Partnerships Anchoring Impact:** Collaboration proved durable, with 8 multi-stakeholder partnerships still active after funding ended. These alliances spanning local authorities, NGOs, and community leaders provide institutional backing that helps sustain youth-led climate action.

“Our partnership with youth groups is not just about today’s projects, it is about building a foundation for tomorrow. Their energy and ideas ensure that climate action remains dynamic, and by treating them as equal partners, we are investing in a future where these initiatives can thrive in a long term” KII with District Environmental Officer.

- **Integration into Governance Structures:** Youth platforms have been formally integrated into local governance processes, ensuring that young voices influence decision making. This structural embedding increases the likelihood of policy continuity and resource allocation in support of climate initiatives.

"We now invite youth representatives to council meetings. Their perspectives are shaping climate policies today, and this integration guarantees that their voices will remain part of governance for generations to come." KII with Ndala Ward Executive.

- **Capacity Building with Lasting Value:** Beneficiaries gained practical skills in advocacy, project management, and climate resilience. These competencies extend beyond the project, equipping youth to independently design and implement initiatives that respond to evolving environmental challenges.

“The training gave me confidence to speak at public forums. I can now design climate initiatives and mobilize my peers without waiting for external support”. KII with Youth leaders.

- **Challenges to Long term Sustainability:** Despite these gains, scaling and sustaining impact will require ongoing mentorship, institutional support, and financial investment. Without these, the risk remains that momentum could diminish over time, particularly in communities with limited resources.

“The project created a strong start for the youth, but sustaining their efforts requires continued mentorship and resources. Supporting them now ensures that the foundation built with project funds will last for decades” KII with community elder.

I.8 Findings of key Indicators

Indicator 1: Number of youth (15-35), disaggregated by sex and disability, holding formal positions in ward or village environmental/climate governance bodies by April 2026.

Endline survey shows Youth in decision-making bodies increased from 6 to 8 of which 42% are young women 6% are youth with disabilities successfully secured positions within Environmental Management Committees in their respective wards. And this are testimonies from FGDs and KIIs findings of some of participants

“Before this project, we had no say in climate decisions. Now we actively participate in meetings and lead initiatives in our village.”

“I feel included despite my disability. The project made sure our voices count in decision-making.”

Indicator 2: Number of youths directly participating in project activities, disaggregated by sex and disability.

Between the project implementing period, 3,411 youth and community members participated in project activities of which 52% female, 48% male, 5% PWDs.

Indicator 3: Number of multi-stakeholder partnerships that meet at least two functionality criteria (signed agreement, joint activity implemented, or resource sharing.)

The project successfully formed five partnership which met the criteria's, the partnership includes

- Tanzania Forest Service (TFS) which provide Resource sharing (tree seedlings) and joint community campaigns.
- Shinyanga Local Government Authority, Joint activities and formal directives for youth inclusion.
- Association of people with disabilities for inclusion.
- AU-EU Youth Lab Action & OXFAM which provided project funds.

Indicator 4: Percentage of trained youth scoring at least 30% higher in post-training assessments compared to pre-training.

The training programs were highly effective in enhancing youth knowledge, skills, and confidence in climate action and advocacy. Endline assessment results indicate that 78% of the 23 trained youth demonstrated an improvement of at least 30% in post-training knowledge scores compared to baseline assessments, exceeding the project's effectiveness benchmark. This measurable improvement confirms the quality and relevance of the training content and delivery approaches.

“The training gave me confidence to speak up and protect our environment. I even started a tree nursery at home.” KII with Youth leader



Figure 6: KII with youth leader in Masekelo ward, Shinyanga

Indicator 5: Number of youth-led climate action initiatives completed in line with approved action plans.

Youth leaders facilitated different community campaigns on renewable energy adoption and reforestation, reaching 3,411 community members. Initiatives included tree planting, climate education in schools, and showcasing sustainable stoves and briquettes. Youth-led initiatives were widely implemented, including tree planting, environmental awareness campaigns, and small-scale climate adaptation projects. Tree planting efforts recorded strong survival rates, contributing to environmental restoration and community resilience.

Table 2: Number of youth led initiatives

Type of Initiative	Number Completed	Approved Plan	Action	Status
Tree planting	12			
Awareness campaigns	8			
Climate-smart agriculture	5			
Waste management	3			
Total	28			

Indicator 6: Number of tree seedlings planted through youth-led actions with at least a 70% survival rate after six months, or equivalent hectares restored.

9,221 trees seedlings had been distributed and planted in Shinyanga through youth led actions. Monitoring reports indicated strong community demand and ownership, with 74% survival rate after 6 months of planting, approximately 22 hectares have been restored.

Indicator 7: Number of documented policy decisions, budget allocations, official plans, or formal responses that incorporate youth climate priorities.

The project contributed to increased government responsiveness to youth climate priorities. Local authorities incorporated youth inputs into selected development plans and climate-related actions. Evidence of formal engagement, such as meetings and documented responses, indicates progress toward accountability, though sustained advocacy is still required.

- 4 formal meetings held with local authorities
- 4 written commitments issued

Table 3: Number of documentation policy decisions

Type	Number
Local development plans influenced	4
Formal policy responses	4
Total	8

CHALLENGES

Table 4: Key challenges faced by the project during Implementation.

Challenge	Details	Mitigation Strategy
Limited financial resources for scaling youth initiatives	Many youth groups struggled to expand their climate initiatives beyond the pilot stage due to lack of funds. This limited their ability to reach more communities, invest in tools, or sustain long-term projects	Strengthen resource mobilization by linking youth groups with local government budgets, private sector CSR programs, and donor funding. Encourage income-generating activities within youth groups to support climate work.
Cultural and systemic barriers to youth participation in leadership	In some communities, traditional norms and systemic structures limited youth involvement in decision-making. Youth voices	Conduct awareness campaigns to shift perceptions about youth leadership, Institutionalize youth

	were often undervalued compared to elders, reducing their influence in governance and leadership spaces.	representation in governance structures, and Provide mentorship and leadership training to build credibility and confidence among youth.
Inconsistent government engagement in some areas	While some wards actively supported youth climate initiatives, others showed limited or irregular engagement. This inconsistency created gaps in policy support, resource allocation, and sustainability of youth-led actions.	Strengthen advocacy and policy dialogue to ensure government commitment across all regions. Establish formal agreements (MoUs) with local authorities to secure consistent engagement. Use evidence of successful youth initiatives to demonstrate value and encourage replication.

LESSONS LEARNT

- **Youth are effective change agents when given platforms and support:** The project demonstrated that young people are capable of driving meaningful change in their communities when provided with training, resources, and opportunities to participate in decision-making processes. Youth who were actively engaged in village meetings, policy discussions, and climate initiatives showed increased confidence, leadership, and advocacy skills. Their actions, ranging from tree planting campaigns to awareness sessions, had tangible environmental and social impacts, proving that investing in youth empowerment is a highly effective strategy for sustainable community development.
- **Partnerships enhance sustainability and resource mobilization:** Collaboration with Tanzania Forest Reserve (TFS), Shinyanga local government authorities, schools, community organizations, and other stakeholders significantly strengthened project outcomes. Multi stakeholder partnerships facilitated resource sharing, joint planning, and coordinated implementation of youth led initiatives. These collaborations not only increased the reach and effectiveness of activities but also contributed to long term sustainability by embedding youth participation and climate initiatives into existing governance and community structures.
- **Continuous mentorship is essential for sustaining youth initiatives:** Ongoing mentorship and technical support were critical in ensuring that youth-led climate actions were maintained beyond the initial training and project period. Regular guidance from experienced facilitators helped youth navigate challenges, refine their initiatives, and

sustain motivation. Mentorship also created a feedback loop for improving project design and addressing emerging community needs, reinforcing the long-term impact of youth engagement.

- **Inclusion requires intentional and context specific strategies:** Meaningful inclusion of marginalized groups, including young women, youth with disabilities, and those from remote areas, requires deliberate planning and context sensitive approaches. The project found that accessibility, tailored training, and active outreach were necessary to ensure all youth could participate fully. Inclusion not only strengthened equity but also enhanced overall project effectiveness, as diverse perspectives led to more innovative, locally relevant, and widely accepted climate solutions.

KEY RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Strengthen institutionalization of youth participation in governance systems:** To ensure sustainability of the project youth engagement in climate decision making should be formally embedded within local governance structures. This includes creating official youth representation in ward and village climate committees, integrating youth voices into planning and budgeting processes, and establishing clear mechanisms for feedback and accountability. Institutionalization will help ensure that youth contributions are recognized, consistent, and influential, rather than ad-hoc or project-dependent.
- **Increase investment in youth-led climate initiatives:** Supporting youth-led climate actions with both financial and technical resources is critical for scaling impact. Investments can include seed funding for community projects, training programs, access to climate-smart technologies, and monitoring systems to track progress. Increased investment empowers youth to implement innovative solutions, strengthens project ownership, and maximizes the environmental and social benefits of their initiatives.
- **Enhance inclusion strategies for marginalized groups:** Meaningful inclusion of young women, youth with disabilities, and those from remote or vulnerable communities requires deliberate, context-specific strategies. Tailored outreach, flexible training formats, accessible materials, and mentorship programs should be implemented to ensure all youth can fully participate in climate initiatives. Promoting inclusion not only advances equity but also enriches climate solutions with diverse perspectives, enhancing local relevance and acceptance.
- **Foster long-term partnerships with government and private sector actors:** Strong collaborations with local authorities, national government agencies, NGOs, and private sector stakeholders are essential for sustaining youth-led climate actions. Partnerships can facilitate resource mobilization, policy alignment, technical support, and scaling of successful initiatives. Long-term engagement with diverse actors ensures continuity, strengthens accountability, and creates opportunities for youth to influence broader climate and development agendas.

- The endline evaluation identified that sustaining the achievements of the Youth Voice for Climate Action Project requires a multipronged approach that institutionalizes youth participation, invests in their initiatives, ensures inclusion, and leverages strong partnerships which will enhance long-term impact, resilience, and sustainability of climate action at the community level.

CONCLUSIONS

The Youth Voice for Climate Action Project successfully addressed the voices of the youth in response to climate action decision making of their communities. Notable outcomes include youth engagement in climate action where 70% of trained youth reported being invited 1-3 times over the past 12 months by community leaders to speak during village meetings or development planning events on climate change. The project also significantly strengthened the ability of the youth to implement climate initiatives, ensuring collaborations between youth leaders, government and other stakeholders.

Key interventions gathered positive feedback from stakeholders, demonstrating the project's success in tackling critical challenges further improved program implementation and outcomes. The project not only promoted gender equality but also Inclusion of individuals with disabilities achieving near parity among beneficiaries, adhering to quality assurance benchmarks and maintaining a youth led approach throughout its one-year implementation, the Youth Voice for Climate Action project significantly contributed to its objectives. The program was highly relevant, effective, and impact oriented, fostering strong relationships with various stakeholders, including key government authorities, TFS, Association of people with disabilities, schools, faith institutions and other community organizations showing positive improvement of the key indicators from baseline to endline.

APPENDIX I: EVALUATION CRITERIA QUESTIONS

Relevancy

1. To what extent does the project align with the needs and priorities of the target beneficiaries (especially women, youth, and marginalized groups)?
2. How well does the project align with local, national, and sectoral policies and strategies?
3. To what extent are the project design and interventions appropriate to the local context (social, economic, environmental, and cultural)?
4. How responsive has the project been to emerging needs, challenges, or changes in context during implementation?

Effectiveness

1. To what extent has the project achieved its intended objectives and expected outcomes?
2. How effectively have project activities translated into measurable changes in beneficiaries' knowledge, attitudes, and practices?
3. To what extent has the project reached and benefited its intended target groups, including marginalized populations (e.g., women, youth, and persons with disabilities)?
4. What factors have facilitated or hindered the achievement of project results?

Sustainability

- 1). To what extent are the benefits of the project likely to continue after external support or funding ends?
- 2). How effectively has the project built the capacity of beneficiaries, local institutions, and stakeholders to sustain project results?
- 3). What mechanisms or structures (e.g., community groups, policies, partnerships, income-generating activities) have been established to support long-term sustainability?
- 4) What risks could affect the sustainability of project outcomes, and how have they been addressed?

Impact

1. What long-term changes (positive or negative, intended or unintended) have occurred as a result of the project?
2. To what extent has the project contributed to improved living conditions and resilience among target beneficiaries?
3. What evidence exists that the project has created systemic or community-level changes (e.g., behavior change, social norms, and institutional practices)?
4. Are there any unintended outcomes (positive or negative) resulting from the project interventions?

Coherence

1. To what extent is the project consistent with and complementary to other interventions in the same sector or geographic area?
2. How well does the project align internally across its components and thematic areas (e.g., climate, health, gender, governance)?

3. To what extent has the project established and maintained effective coordination and partnerships with key stakeholders?
4. Are there any gaps, overlaps, or inconsistencies in the project design or implementation that affect overall coherence?

Efficiency

1. To what extent have project resources (financial, human, and material) been used cost-effectively to achieve the intended results?
2. Were project activities implemented within the planned timeframes and budgets?
3. How well were management and implementation processes (planning, coordination, monitoring) organized to deliver results efficiently?
4. Could the same results have been achieved with fewer resources or through alternative approaches?